

Marmalio Apply

Complete Guide -- English Master v1.0

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Market Distinctions

This system launches in English targeting the USA, Canada, UK, Australia, and international English-speaking customers together. These markets do not share one resume convention, and no single format in this kit is presented as correct for every country. This file exists so no other file in this kit has to guess — it's the single reference every template, prompt, and workflow points back to.

Quick reference by market

Read your block, then use the detailed sections below for the specifics behind each line.

USA / Canada resume guidance: call it a "resume." 1 page under ~8–10 years of experience, 2 pages maximum otherwise. No photo, no date of birth, no marital status, no nationality. Currency: USD (USA) / CAD (Canada).

UK CV guidance: call it a "CV" — same document, different label. 2 pages is the standard expectation, even for less experienced candidates. Photo, date of birth, and marital status are uncommon on modern CVs, though norms have loosened over time. Currency: GBP.

Australia guidance: call it a "CV." 2–3 pages is commonly accepted — longer than US/Canada norms. Same personal-information defaults as the UK (no photo, no DOB, no marital status expected). Currency: AUD.

General international guidance (outside these four): do not assume the USA/Canada defaults above are universal. Length, personal-information norms, and even whether a photo is expected vary significantly by country — some markets outside the four above do expect a photo or date of birth. Check the specific market's current norms before applying any of this kit's defaults, and treat the USA/Canada/UK/Australia guidance as a safe reference point, not a global rule.

Terminology: "resume" vs "CV"

This kit uses "**resume**" as its working term throughout, for consistency. If you're in the UK or Australia, your local term is "**CV**" — and it means the same thing this kit calls a resume (unlike in the US/Canada, where "CV" specifically means a long-form academic/research document). Wherever you see "resume" in this kit, UK/Australia users should read it as "CV." Nothing about the content or structure changes — only the label.

Length

Market	Typical length
USA / Canada	1 page under ~8–10 years of experience; 2 pages maximum otherwise
UK	2 pages is the standard expectation, even for less experienced candidates
Australia	2–3 pages is commonly accepted, longer than US norms
International (elsewhere)	Varies significantly — check local norms before assuming US length rules apply

Both templates in the resume templates default to the US/Canada-style length guidance in their formatting notes. If you're building a UK, Australian, or other-market version, adjust the target length using this table, not the US default.

Personal information

USA / Canada: no photo, no date of birth, no marital status, no nationality — including these is actively discouraged and can create legal risk for the employer, which is why some US/Canada employers will discard an application that includes them.

UK / Australia: a photo is not expected and is uncommon on modern CVs; date of birth and marital status are also uncommon now, though norms have shifted over time and are less strictly enforced than in the US/Canada.

International (elsewhere): norms vary widely — some markets outside the four above do expect a photo or date of birth. This kit's templates deliberately omit all of this by default (see the resume templates) because that default is safe for USA/Canada/UK/Australia; do not add personal details without checking the specific market's current norms first.

Address format

The templates use [City, State/Country] deliberately, not a full street address — this is accepted practice across all four launch markets and avoids assuming any one country's address format. Do not expand this to a full postal address unless a specific employer's application system requires it.

Dates

This kit's templates use written-out month/year formats (e.g., "Jan 2021 – Present") specifically to avoid the MM/DD vs. DD/MM ambiguity between US and most other English-speaking markets (the US reads 03/04/2021 as March 4th; the UK, Canada in practice, and Australia commonly read the same string as April 3rd). Keep dates in this written-out format in every market version — never fall back to a slash-separated numeric date.

Spelling

This master version uses **American spelling** (e.g., "optimization," "summarize," "organize") as its base, since it's the most common default in both general use and in AI assistants' own output. UK and Australian English conventionally use British spelling (e.g., "optimisation," "summarise," "organise"). This is a known, minor adaptation — not a blocker to using the US-spelled master today, but worth a light spelling pass for a dedicated UK/Australia release later .

Currency and salary research (Prompt 08)

The Salary Negotiation prompt (Prompt 08, Salary Negotiation, in the Prompt Library) never supplies a number itself — you always provide your own researched range. Use your local market's sources and currency:

Market	Common salary-research sources	Currency
USA	Glassdoor, levels.fyi, Payscale	USD
Canada	Glassdoor Canada, Payscale Canada	CAD
UK	Glassdoor UK, Reed, Payscale UK	GBP
Australia	Seek, Glassdoor Australia, Payscale Australia	AUD

Legal and anti-discrimination context

This system makes no legal claims and gives no legal advice (see the Limitations & Safe Use chapter). Anti-discrimination norms around what to include or omit in an application (photo, age, marital status, and similar) differ by country — e.g., US federal and state law, the UK's Equality Act 2010, and Australia's federal and state anti-discrimination framework each shape local hiring-document norms differently. This kit's defaults (no photo, no DOB, no marital status) are a safe baseline across all four launch markets, not a legal opinion about any one of them.

Workflow Overview

This is the full map of the system. Each step lists what it needs, what it produces, and which file to open next.

Step 1 — Job Posting Analysis

File: Prompt 01, Job Posting Analysis, in the Prompt Library

Input: the full text of one job posting.

Output: a structured breakdown of must-have requirements, nice-to-have requirements, recurring keywords/themes, and anything ambiguous or unclear in the posting.

Why it comes first: every later step tailors your materials to this specific role. Skipping this step is the single most common reason tailored materials end up generic.

Step 2 — Experience Inventory

File: Prompt 02, Experience Inventory, in the Prompt Library

Input: your own answers to a structured set of questions about your real work history, education, and projects.

Output: a single, organized document containing only facts you provided — no rewriting, no polish yet. This is the source of truth for every step that follows.

Why it matters: this is the anti-fabrication safeguard. Nothing downstream is allowed to introduce a fact that isn't already in this document.

Step 3 — Resume Bullet Rewrite

File: Prompt 03, Resume Bullet Rewrite, in the Prompt Library

Input: the relevant section(s) of your Step 2 inventory, plus the themes identified in Step 1.

Output: clear, results-oriented resume bullets — rephrased and structured, with zero new facts added. Any bullet that would benefit from a metric you didn't provide is flagged, not invented.

Truth boundary: every rewritten bullet must be traceable word-for-fact back to Step 2.

Step 4 — Resume Tailoring

File: Prompt 04, Resume Tailoring, in the Prompt Library

Input: your rewritten bullets (Step 3), the job posting analysis (Step 1), and one of the two templates in the resume templates.

Output: a role-tailored resume draft — the right bullets, in the right order, for this specific posting. Tailoring here means selection and ordering, never invention.

Step 5 — Cover Letter

File: Prompt 05, Cover Letter, in the Prompt Library

Input: your experience inventory (Step 2), the job posting analysis (Step 1), and a tone preference.

Output: a 250–350 word cover letter grounded only in what Steps 1–2 established, in the cover letter template.

Step 6 — LinkedIn Optimization

File: the LinkedIn Optimization Workflow chapter (uses Prompt 06, LinkedIn Headline & Summary, in the Prompt Library)

Input: your experience inventory and target roles/industries.

Output: three headline options and a rewritten About section, consistent with your resume and cover letter.

Step 7 — STAR Interview Preparation

File: the STAR Interview Preparation Workflow chapter (uses Prompt 07, STAR Interview Preparation, in the Prompt Library)

Input: your experience inventory, the job posting analysis, and a list of likely interview questions.

Output: 5–8 STAR-format answers built from your real stories, with gaps flagged rather than filled.

Step 8 — Salary Negotiation Preparation (optional)

File: the Salary Negotiation Workflow chapter (uses Prompt 08, Salary Negotiation, in the Prompt Library)

Input: market-range data you have researched yourself (e.g., from sites like Glassdoor or levels.fyi) and your inventory highlights.

Output: a negotiation script, a response to a lowball offer, and a walk-away-criteria worksheet — using only the numbers you supplied.

Step 9 — Career-Change Workflow (optional)

File: the Career-Change Workflow chapter (uses Prompt 09, Career-Change Narrative, in the Prompt Library)

Input: your inventory from your prior field and the target field's requirements from Step 1.

Output: a transferable-skills bridge narrative that is honest about what's directly relevant, what transfers indirectly, and what you're still building toward — never a narrative that implies direct experience you don't have.

Final pass — Truth & Quality Checklist

File: the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist

Run every output from Steps 3–9 through this checklist before you send anything to an employer. This step is not optional.

LinkedIn Optimization Workflow

When to use this

After you've completed your Experience Inventory (Prompt 02) and ideally after your resume is tailored (Step 4), since your LinkedIn profile should be consistent with — not identical to — your resume.

Steps

1. **Run Prompt 06** (Prompt 06, LinkedIn Headline & Summary, in the Prompt Library) using your full Experience Inventory and your target roles/industries (this can be broader than one specific posting — LinkedIn is not a single-application document).
2. **Pick a headline.** Of the three options produced, choose the one that best matches how you actually want to be found in recruiter search — skills-forward if you want to be found by capability, role-forward if you want to be found by job title.
3. **Update your About section** using the drafted version, after running it through the Truth Check in Prompt 06.
4. **Update your Experience section entries** on LinkedIn using your Prompt 03 (Resume Bullet Rewrite) output for each role — you can reuse the same bullets, but LinkedIn allows slightly more narrative framing than a resume bullet. Do not add anything here that isn't already in your inventory.
5. **Update your Skills section** to match the Skills list in your tailored resume — do not add a skill on LinkedIn that isn't on your resume or in your inventory; inconsistency between the two is itself a credibility risk, separate from the fabrication risk.
6. **Featured section (optional):** if you have a real, shareable work sample (a project, a published article, a portfolio link), add it here. Do not fabricate a portfolio item.

Consistency check

Before you consider this step done, open your resume and your LinkedIn profile side by side. Every factual claim (employer, title, dates, skills) must match exactly. A mismatch here is one of the most common things a hiring manager notices immediately.

Run the Truth & Quality Checklist

Before publishing changes to your live profile, run the updated headline and About section through the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist.

STAR Interview Preparation Workflow

When to use this

Once you have an interview scheduled, or once you want to be ready before applying. Requires your Experience Inventory and, ideally, your Job Posting Analysis for the specific role.

Steps

1. **Gather any known questions.** Check the job posting, the company's careers page, and sites like Glassdoor for questions previous candidates report being asked for this company/role. This is optional — Prompt 07 can suggest likely questions on its own.

2. **Run Prompt 07** (Prompt 07, STAR Interview Preparation, in the Prompt Library) with your Experience Inventory, Job Posting Analysis, and any known questions.
3. **Review every [NO MATCHING STORY YET] flag.** These are the most valuable output of this step, not a failure — they tell you exactly where you need to think of a real example before the interview. Spend time here rather than skipping past it.
4. **Practice out loud, not just on paper.** Read each STAR answer aloud once, then again from memory. If you stumble on the Result section because it's marked [OUTCOME NOT SPECIFIED IN INVENTORY], decide now whether you can honestly estimate an outcome for the interview (and say so as an estimate) or whether you'll describe the action and what you learned instead.
5. **Prepare 2–3 questions to ask the interviewer,** based on the ambiguous/unclear items flagged in your Job Posting Analysis (Prompt 01, section 5) — these make genuinely better questions than generic ones, because they come from something specifically unclear in this posting.

Truth check specific to interviews

Interview answers are spoken, not submitted as a document — there's a temptation to embellish "just a little" once you're in the room. Practicing from the STAR answers as written, including their honest gaps, is what prevents that from happening under pressure.

Run the Truth & Quality Checklist

Before your interview, run your final set of STAR answers through the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist.

Salary Negotiation Workflow

When to use this

Once you have an offer, or once you know an offer is imminent. This step depends on market research you do yourself — it is not a substitute for that research.

Steps

1. **Research your market range first, outside this system.** Use sites like Glassdoor, levels.fyi, Payscale, or LinkedIn Salary for your specific title, location, and experience level. Write down the range and where it came from.
2. **Run Prompt 08** (Prompt 08, Salary Negotiation, in the Prompt Library) with your researched range, your relevant Experience Inventory highlights, and your current offer details if you have one.
3. **Check every dollar figure in the output** against what you provided (this is called out explicitly in Prompt 08's Truth Check — it matters more here than anywhere else in the system, because a wrong number spoken out loud to an employer is hard to walk back).
4. **Fill out the walk-away-criteria worksheet honestly,** before the negotiation conversation, not during it. Decide your minimum acceptable total compensation and your non-negotiables in advance.
5. **Practice the opening script and the lowball-response script out loud.** Negotiation conversations move fast; having practiced the actual words reduces the chance of freezing or over-conceding in the moment.

What this step will not do for you

It will not tell you what you're worth, what the market rate is, or whether to accept an offer — those require your own research and judgment. This step only helps you organize and rehearse a negotiation built on numbers you already have.

Run the Truth & Quality Checklist

Before the negotiation conversation, run your scripts through the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist, paying particular attention to the numeric-accuracy items.

Career-Change Workflow

When to use this

When you're applying to a field or role type that differs meaningfully from your prior experience, and a standard tailored resume (Step 4) would understate — or risk overstating — how your background applies.

Steps

1. **Complete your Experience Inventory (Prompt 02) for your prior field first**, in full, before starting this workflow.
2. **Run a Job Posting Analysis (Prompt 01) on a representative posting in your target field**, even if it's not the exact role you'll apply to — you need its requirements as an input here.
3. **Run Prompt 09** (Prompt 09, Career-Change Narrative, in the Prompt Library) with both of the above.
4. **Read the three lists it produces carefully**, especially "Gaps to Acknowledge." For each gap, decide on one of three honest responses: (a) address it directly in your cover letter or interview ("I don't have direct X experience, but I've done Y which required a similar skill"), (b) start closing it before you apply (a short course, a small project, a certification), or (c) accept it as a real gap and target roles/postings where it matters less.
5. **Use Resume Template 2** (Resume Template 2), the skills-forward variant, so the "Core Strengths" section can lead with your directly- and partially-transferable skills from lists 1 and 2, ahead of a chronological history that may look less directly relevant on its own.
6. **Adapt the narrative paragraph** into your cover letter (Prompt 05) and be ready to say a version of it out loud in interviews (Prompt 07) — consistency across all three matters more in a career change than in a same-field application, since this is the story an employer is most likely to probe.

The honesty boundary in this workflow specifically

A career-change narrative is where the temptation to overstate is strongest, because "transferable skills" language can slide into implying direct experience without ever stating an outright falsehood. Prompt 09's Truth Check exists specifically for this: read the narrative on its own and ask whether an average reader would walk away believing you have more direct experience than you do.

Run the Truth & Quality Checklist

Before using the narrative anywhere, run it through the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist.

Limitations and Safe Use

Read this before you use any part of this system. It exists so you know exactly what this product does and does not do.

What this system is

A structured workflow and prompt library that helps you organize your own, real experience into tailored application materials — resume, cover letter, LinkedIn profile, interview preparation, salary negotiation preparation, and a career-change narrative where relevant — using AI assistants like ChatGPT or Claude as a drafting and organizing tool.

What this system is not, and does not claim

- **This is not a guarantee of an interview.** No document, however well-tailored, can guarantee how any specific employer or hiring process will respond.
- **This is not a guarantee of a job offer.** Hiring decisions depend on many factors outside any application document's control.
- **This does not "beat" applicant tracking systems.** No product can make that claim honestly — ATS software varies widely between employers and changes over time. This system produces a plain, single-column, consistently-structured document (described as "ATS-conscious"), which is a reasonable, honest description of good formatting practice — not a claim about how any specific system will process it.
- **This does not verify facts.** The system does not check whether your dates, titles, or claims are accurate — that responsibility stays with you. It only prevents the AI from adding facts you did not provide; it cannot catch an inaccurate fact you did provide.
- **This is not legal, tax, immigration, or career-counseling advice.** If your job search involves visa status, employment law questions, or a situation requiring professional guidance, consult a qualified professional — this system does not cover that.
- **This does not replace your own judgment.** Every output in this system is a draft for you to review, correct, and approve — not a finished document to submit unread.

Your responsibility as the user

- You are responsible for the accuracy of everything you submit to an employer, recruiter, or on a professional profile, including anything produced with this system's help.
- You are responsible for running the Truth & Quality Checklist (the Truth, Quality & Safe-Use Checklist) before using any output.
- If an AI assistant's output ever states something you did not tell it, that is a fabrication to correct using the Refinement Step in the relevant prompt file — not something to leave in place because it "sounds good."

AI assistant behavior

This system's prompts are written to instruct AI assistants not to invent information. AI assistants can still make mistakes or ignore instructions occasionally. The Truth Check step included with every prompt exists specifically to catch this — it is a required step, not an optional one.

Refunds and support

Refund and support terms are defined on the product page where you purchased this kit and are subject to final confirmation before publication.

Worked Examples

Three complete, fictional, start-to-finish walkthroughs of the system. None of these people are real; no fact in any of them was invented for a real candidate -- they exist only to demonstrate the workflow.

Mid-Career Professional

This is a fictional example created to illustrate the system. "Alex Rivera" is not a real person. No facts here come from a real candidate — they were invented for this demonstration only, which is why this file (and only this file, plus the other two example files) is exempt from the "never invent a candidate's experience" rule: there is no real candidate to misrepresent.

Scenario

Alex Rivera has 8 years of experience in retail operations, currently an Assistant Store Manager, applying for a Regional Operations Manager role at a mid-size retail chain.

Step 2 output — Experience Inventory excerpt

Assistant Store Manager — Northline Retail Co. (2021–present)

- Responsible for day-to-day operations of a 22-person store, including scheduling, inventory counts, and opening/closing procedures.
- Led the rollout of a new point-of-sale system across the store; trained all 22 staff members over a two-week period.
- Reduced staff scheduling conflicts by building a new shift-swap request process; went from an estimated 5-6 scheduling complaints per month to about 1 per month, based on manager log notes.
- Managed relationships with 4 regional suppliers for stock ordering.

Sales Associate → Shift Lead — Northline Retail Co. (2017–2021)

- Promoted to Shift Lead after 18 months.
- Consistently among the top 3 associates for customer satisfaction survey scores (store used a 1-5 scale; my average was 4.7, per quarterly manager reviews).

Step 3 output — Rewritten bullets (excerpt)

- Managed daily operations for a 22-person retail store, including scheduling, inventory, and opening/closing procedures.
- Led company-wide POS system rollout at store level, training 22 staff members over two weeks.
- Redesigned shift-swap process, reducing scheduling complaints from an estimated 5–6 per month to approximately 1 per month.
- Managed ordering relationships with 4 regional suppliers.

Step 4 output — Tailored resume excerpt (Template 1)

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Store Manager — Northline Retail Co. 2021 – Present

- Managed daily operations for a 22-person retail store, including scheduling, inventory, and opening/closing procedures.
- Led company-wide POS system rollout at store level, training 22 staff members over two weeks.
- Redesigned shift-swap process, reducing scheduling complaints from an estimated 5–6 per month to approximately 1 per month.

(Omitted from this tailored version: supplier relationship bullet — job posting analysis found no emphasis on vendor/supplier management for this Regional Operations Manager posting, so it was deprioritized, not deleted from the master bullet list.)

Step 5 output — Cover letter opening (excerpt)

I'm applying for the Regional Operations Manager role because I've spent the last four years doing, at a single-store level, exactly what this role asks for at a regional one: keeping day-to-day operations running smoothly while leading change, like the POS rollout I managed across a 22-person team in two weeks.

Step 6 output — LinkedIn headline options

1. Retail Operations Manager | Store Operations, Team Training, Process Improvement
2. Assistant Store Manager → Regional Operations | 8 Years in Retail Operations
3. Operations Leader | Reduced Scheduling Conflicts 80% Through Process Redesign

Step 7 output — One STAR answer (excerpt)

Question: "Tell me about a time you led a change that affected your whole team."

- **Situation:** Our store was assigned to roll out a new company-wide POS system with a two-week deployment window.
- **Task:** I was responsible for training all 22 staff members and ensuring the store stayed operational during the transition.
- **Action:** I split staff into small training groups by shift, ran hands-on sessions during slower hours, and created a one-page quick-reference guide for common issues during the first week.
- **Result:** All 22 staff were trained within the two-week window, and based on my own manager log notes, transaction errors during week one of live use were noticeably lower than what colleagues at a sister store described for their rollout — though I don't have their exact numbers to compare directly.

(Note the honest hedge in the Result — the comparison to the sister store is qualitative, not a fabricated statistic, because no exact comparative number was ever provided.)

Career Changer

This is a fictional example created to illustrate the system. "Priya Desai" is not a real person. No facts here come from a real candidate — they were invented for this demonstration only.

Scenario

Priya Desai has spent 6 years as a high school biology teacher and is transitioning into corporate Learning & Development / Instructional Design roles.

Step 2 output — Experience Inventory excerpt (prior field)

High School Biology Teacher — Lakeside High School (2018–present)

- Designed and delivered curriculum for 5 sections of biology per year, roughly 150 students total.
- Built a redesigned lab-safety training module after a district audit flagged inconsistent compliance; module adopted by 2 other teachers in the department the following year.
- Regularly used learning-management software (Google Classroom) to distribute materials and track assignment completion.
- Mentored 3 first-year teachers informally on classroom management and lesson planning.

Step 9 output — Career-change narrative lists (excerpt)

Directly transferable:

- Instructional design experience: built a training module (lab-safety) that was adopted beyond my own use — directly relevant to designing corporate training content.
- Curriculum design at scale (150 students/year) demonstrates experience structuring content for a large, varied audience.

Partially transferable:

- Google Classroom usage shows LMS familiarity, but not with corporate-standard LMS platforms (e.g., Cornerstone, Workday Learning) — would need to name this gap honestly rather than implying direct platform experience.
- Mentoring first-year teachers relates to coaching/onboarding design, but was informal, not a structured program — framed as "informal mentoring," not "developed a formal onboarding program."

Gaps to acknowledge:

- No formal instructional design certification (e.g., ATD, e-learning authoring tools like Articulate).
- No corporate environment experience.

Step 9 output — Narrative paragraph

After six years designing and delivering curriculum for over 150 students a year, including a lab-safety training module that two colleagues adopted beyond my own classroom, I'm moving my instructional design experience into a corporate L&D context. I don't yet have hands-on experience with corporate authoring tools like

Articulate, and I'm addressing that directly through [a specific course or project, to be filled in honestly] — but the core skill this role needs, designing training that people actually retain and use, is exactly what I've been doing for six years.

Step 4 output — Tailored resume excerpt (Template 2, skills-forward)

CORE STRENGTHS

Instructional Design: Built and iterated curriculum for 150+ students annually; designed a lab-safety training module adopted by 2 additional instructors.

Content Delivery at Scale: Managed learning materials and progress tracking for 5 concurrent course sections using Google Classroom.

Coaching & Onboarding: Informally mentored 3 first-year teachers on classroom management and planning.

EXPERIENCE

High School Biology Teacher — Lakeside High School 2018 — Present

- Designed and delivered curriculum for 5 sections (~150 students) annually.
- Built a lab-safety training module adopted by 2 other teachers following a district compliance audit.

Step 6 output — LinkedIn headline options

1. Instructional Designer (Transitioning from Education) | Curriculum Design, Training Content, LMS
2. Former Educator → L&D | 6 Years Designing Training That People Actually Use
3. Curriculum & Training Design | 150+ Learners/Year | Moving into Corporate L&D

Recent Graduate

This is a fictional example created to illustrate the system. "Jordan Kim" is not a real person. No facts here come from a real candidate — they were invented for this demonstration only.

Scenario

Jordan Kim graduated six months ago with a marketing degree, completed one internship, and is applying for an entry-level Marketing Coordinator role.

Step 2 output — Experience Inventory excerpt

Marketing Intern — Brightside Co. (Summer, prior year, 10 weeks)

- Assisted with scheduling and writing captions for the company's Instagram and TikTok accounts, roughly 3 posts per week.
- Built a simple spreadsheet to track which post types (product photo, behind-the-scenes, promo) got the most likes/comments over the internship period; noticed behind-the-scenes posts got the most engagement, though I don't have exact numbers saved anymore.
- Sat in on 2 planning meetings for a product launch campaign, took notes, no direct decision-making role.

Marketing Capstone Project — University (final semester)

- Group project (team of 4): created a mock social media marketing plan for a local nonprofit as a class assignment. I was responsible for the content calendar and caption drafts specifically, not the full plan.
- Presented the project to the class and one guest evaluator from a local marketing agency.

Skills: Canva (used throughout internship and capstone), basic Google Analytics (from one course), Instagram/TikTok native scheduling tools.

Step 3 output — Rewritten bullets (excerpt)

- Wrote and scheduled 3 social media posts per week across Instagram and TikTok during a 10-week marketing internship.
- Tracked post-type engagement patterns using a self-built spreadsheet; identified behind-the-scenes content as a stronger-performing format based on internship-period observation. [METRIC NEEDED: exact engagement numbers not retained from internship — noted as observation, not quantified]
- Contributed content calendar and caption drafts to a 4-person capstone marketing plan for a local nonprofit, presented to an industry evaluator.

Step 4 output — Tailored resume excerpt (Template 2, skills-forward — recommended for thin work history)

CORE STRENGTHS

Content Creation: Wrote and scheduled 3 social posts/week (Instagram, TikTok) during a 10-week internship; proficient in Canva.

Analytical Thinking: Built a tracking spreadsheet to compare post-type engagement, informing content strategy observations.

Collaboration: Contributed to a 4-person capstone marketing plan presented to an industry evaluator.

EXPERIENCE

Marketing Intern — Brightside Co. Summer [Year]

- Wrote and scheduled 3 social media posts per week across Instagram and TikTok.
- Built a tracking spreadsheet comparing engagement by post type; identified behind-the-scenes content as a stronger-performing format.
- Attended 2 campaign planning meetings for a product launch.

EDUCATION

B.A. Marketing — [University Name] [Graduation Year]

PROJECTS

Nonprofit Social Media Marketing Plan (Capstone) — led content calendar and caption drafts for a 4-person team project; presented to an industry evaluator.

Step 5 output — Cover letter opening (excerpt)

I'm applying for the Marketing Coordinator role because it matches exactly the kind of hands-on content work I did during my internship at Brightside Co. — writing and scheduling posts, then actually tracking what performed and why, not just producing content and moving on.

Step 7 output — One STAR answer (excerpt)

Question: "Tell me about a time you used data to make a decision, even informally."

- **Situation:** During my internship, we were posting a mix of content types without a clear sense of what was working.
- **Task:** No one asked me to do this, but I wanted to understand our engagement patterns better.
- **Action:** I built a simple spreadsheet logging post type, date, and likes/comments for each post over the internship.
- **Result:** The pattern suggested behind-the-scenes posts performed better than product photos, which I shared informally with my supervisor near the end of the internship. I don't have the exact numbers anymore since the file was on the company's internal drive, so I can speak to the pattern but not exact figures if asked.

(Note the honest limitation stated directly in the answer — this is deliberate, not a weakness to hide.)

Before and After Examples

These comparisons use the same fictional candidates from the worked examples. Every "after" version uses only facts present in the "before" version — nothing is added. The value shown here is clarity, structure, and tailoring, not invented achievements. This is deliberate: a system that could only show improvement by inventing better facts would be the exact failure mode this product exists to prevent.

Example 1 — Generic AI output vs. this system's output (Alex Rivera, mid-career)

Before — typical generic AI-generated bullet, from a vague one-line prompt ("make my resume bullet about the POS rollout sound better"):

Spearheaded a transformative company-wide technology initiative, dramatically improving operational efficiency and team performance.

What's wrong with this: "transformative," "dramatically," and "company-wide" are not supported by anything in Alex's actual inventory. This bullet could describe almost any project — it's impressive-sounding and empty.

After — this system's output (Prompt 03, grounded in the actual inventory):

Led company-wide POS system rollout at store level, training 22 staff members over two weeks.

Same underlying fact. Specific, checkable, and honest. A hiring manager can ask a follow-up question about this bullet and get a real answer, because there's a real story behind every word.

Example 2 — Vague summary vs. tailored summary (Priya Desai, career changer)

Before — generic career-change opening, the kind produced by a one-line prompt with no system behind it:

Passionate educator with a proven track record of success, ready to bring my extensive experience to a dynamic new field.

What's wrong: "proven track record of success" and "extensive experience" claim nothing specific and, worse, blur the fact that this is a career change — a hiring manager reading this has no idea what actually transfers and what doesn't.

After — this system's output (Prompt 09, honest transferable-skills framing):

After six years designing and delivering curriculum for over 150 students a year, including a lab-safety training module that two colleagues adopted beyond my own classroom, I'm moving my instructional design experience into a corporate L&D context.

Specific, honest about being a transition, and gives the reader something concrete to evaluate — the training module story — instead of an empty claim.

Example 3 — Padded bullet vs. honest-gap bullet (Jordan Kim, recent graduate)

Before — the kind of output produced when an AI is asked to "make it sound more impressive" without a truth-check step:

Spearheaded a comprehensive social media analytics strategy that significantly boosted audience engagement across multiple platforms.

What's wrong: Jordan tracked engagement informally in a personal spreadsheet during an internship and doesn't have the exact numbers anymore. "Spearheaded," "comprehensive strategy," and "significantly boosted" all overstate what actually happened — and would fall apart under a single follow-up question in an interview.

After — this system's output (Prompt 03, with the metric gap flagged honestly):

Built a tracking spreadsheet comparing engagement by post type; identified behind-the-scenes content as a stronger-performing format. [METRIC NEEDED: exact engagement numbers not retained from internship — noted as observation, not quantified]

The bracketed note doesn't go on the final resume — it's a flag for Jordan to either track down the real numbers before finalizing, or keep the bullet as a qualitative observation. Either way, nothing false ends up in the final document.

What this demonstrates

In all three cases, the "after" version is not a bigger claim than the "before" version — in every case, it is a **smaller, more specific, fully checkable claim**. That is the entire value proposition of this system: not making your background sound bigger, but making it sound exactly as true as it is, clearly enough that it actually works.